THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 5: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why were mahajanapadas frequently at war? 1

(a) peace treaties
(b) no kings
(c) competition for land, resources and power
(d) no resources

2. Which characteristic of the Second Urbanisation shows continuity with the First? 1

(a) iron use **(b)** Buddhism
(c) trade and craft production **(d)** coins

3. Why might a king prefer taxes in coin rather than in kind? 1

(a) harder to count **(b)** cannot be used
(c) easier to store and spend **(d)** spoils quickly

4. Which feature shows the persistence of inequality in cities? 1

(a) same houses **(b)** no walls
(c) same goods **(d)** differences in houses and goods

5. How does the use of the moat relate to urban safety? 1

(a) creates a barrier to attackers **(b)** helps farming
(c) increases floods **(d)** helps trade

6. Which situation shows the effect of food surplus? 1

(a) growth of specialist crafts **(b)** fall of cities
(c) no trade **(d)** no coins

7. What does the shift from janapada to mahajanapada indicate? 1

(a) decline of states **(b)** decline of kings
(c) decline of cities **(d)** consolidation of territory and power

8. Why do historians treat literary descriptions of cities cautiously? 1

(a) they never exist **(b)** they are drawings
(c) they may exaggerate or reflect ideals **(d)** they are always accurate

9. A text describes a gate with narrow passages and watchtowers. The intention was 1

(a) decoration **(b)** trade
(c) defence and control of movement **(d)** music

10. Which of these inferences is NOT supported by finding a hoard of punch-marked coins? 1

(a) trade **(b)** existence of paper money
(c) metal use **(d)** state authority

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did iron change warfare? 2

12. Why do some cities survive for millennia? 2

13. Why did kings build forts? 2

14. Why did inequality grow? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine how trade routes and cities were interdependent. 3

16. Discuss the role of guilds in urban life. 3

17. Evaluate how a mint and coins benefit rulers and traders. 3

OR

Compare the roles of kings and assemblies. 3

18. Examine the challenge of reconstructing the past from limited evidence. 3

OR

Examine the continuities between the First and Second Urbanisations. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Analyse the factors behind Magadha's rise and its consequences. 5

OR

Explain how fortification and administration made the cities secure and well-ordered. 5

20. Compare the First and Second Urbanisations in technology, planning and society. 5

OR

Evaluate the argument that the mahajanapadas show early experiments in democracy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND